



Taking Action Based on Community Feedback NRA Conference Hall, 22nd March 2017

Participants: ActionAid, CARE Nepal, Caritas Germany, CFP, DFID, EU, Habitat for Humanity, ICCO Cooperation, IFMR/Harvard, INF Nepal, JICA TPIS-ERP, Japanese Red Cross, Lumanti, NOMAD, NRA, Oxfam Nepal, British Red Cross, IFRC, Samaritan's Purse, Save the Children, Tearfund Nepal, UMN, UNDP, and UNOPS.

Introduction

This was the first, of what will be regular meetings where the [Common Feedback Project \(CFP\)](#) and the [Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Platform \(HRRP\)](#) will look to work with reconstruction stakeholders to convert community feedback on the reconstruction process into action. The presentation slides are available on the HRRP website [here](#), and this session summary provides an overview of the questions and discussion, as well as a list of proposed actions, reference documents, and contact details for the presenters.

Questions and Discussion

Q: Does the Common Feedback Project (CFP) survey consult communities regarding their perceptions of the 17 models in [volume 1 of the DUDBC design catalogue](#) or the [4 models which NRA recently published](#)? Do you have any data on why communities are happy or unhappy with these models, or whether they consider them to be fit for purpose?

- CFP does not have a specific question in the survey about the 17 models, but there are lots of people who say that the models are not appropriate through the open question section, or general feedback. The issues with the models are related to the size, cultural factors, and lifestyle concerns, such as the absence of storage for grains. People are keen to incorporate indigenous building practices and use locally available resources. As raised during the presentation, it may be beneficial for POs engineers to support communities to develop appropriate designs.
- DFID gave an example from Dhading where they met a DL-PIU sub-engineer who only had reference to the 17 designs and highlighted that the information on the ground is that you must adhere only to these designs. DFID also informed that recently there has been more openness for NRA to look at locally appropriate designs, and this is one of the projects under Dr. Parajuli's technical working group. Once finalised these designs should be promoted through the DL-PIU engineers
- It was also raised that the 17 designs were published in October 2015 and there are now some conflicts between these designs and the inspection SOP published by the NRA in December 2016. This may leave households that followed the 17 designs facing problems with the inspection process.
- HRRP informed that the recently completed District Technical Workshops, summary report available [here](#), had raised this and that HRRP has now prepared a comparison between the technical standards in the [inspection SOP](#) and the [NBC](#) and will be follow up with MoUD CL-PIU on this.
- As households require engineers support to understand the inspection SOP UNDP recommended that a simplified version be prepared for households. JICA informed that they have already prepared booklets on this which are available [here](#).
- UNDP also informed that some houses have included required elements but not 100% correctly, i.e. buttress should be 2ft, but is constructed as 1.5 ft. HRRP informed that the technical working group under Dr. Parajuli is also [working on preparing a scoring system for compliance which will look to address issues such as this](#).
- Cordaid informed that in Rasuwa most people do not want to use the 17 models and so Cordaid, and their partner Lumanti, have worked with communities to design five low cost house types which have been approved by government.



- NRA Joint Secretary informed that in a municipality, the municipal engineers will check the designs and must approve before construction starts. In VDCs, DL-PIU engineers can support but it is not compulsory that the design be approved as part of a building permit process.
- It was suggested that models could be improved by including scope for extension and that to safely allow for this it needs to be designed in during the approval process.

Q: CFP raised that given the issues with the differences between the information being provided by DL-PIU engineers and by PO engineers leaving people unsure who to trust and afraid that they won't be able to access the next tranches, is there any point in having PO engineers in place if we can't find a way to bridge this gap?

- The IFRC informed that in Red Cross working areas support with design preparation and approval is highly sought after. The Red Cross brought NRA officials to communities to interact with them on this issue and their technical staff are supporting communities to develop designs and get them approved.
- CFP have found that many people ask if they can use a design other than the 17 models, and they can but it is a complicated and often expensive process so it would be good if more support like this for design preparation and approval could be provided to communities.
- JICA felt that POs engineers are important and had played a vital role in providing information, training, support, etc. before the DL-PIU engineers were deployed. They have found that it works well to form technical coordination committees at VDC level to ensure uniform understanding and approach amongst all technical staff in the VDC. From April, they will be rolling out 'mobile masons' who will be able to provide households with information and to offer some supervision support for construction works. They are also trying to look at what works best for orientations and have tried providing half day sessions, or providing books, and theatre performances and are collecting information on what people prefer.
- Save the Children are already using the mobile masons approach and have one mason per roughly 15 houses. The masons provide social mobilisation and technical support. The masons are experienced and must go through Save the Children training before taking on the role. In general, they are from the community in which they work and this has been found to make it easier for them to communicate with the households.
- UNDP have been bringing trained masons to a well-known place in the VDC to update them on what is happening with policy, what the minimum requirements are, etc. and then the masons are expected to bring this information back to the communities where they work. UNDP also have a mobile technical clinic.

Q: UNOPS – where POs are already supporting with radio messages, is this being coordinated with NRA to ensure messages are correct and up to date? It is important to avoid any incorrect information being sent out as this would create a lot of problems. NRA has communications team who are willing to meet with people individually or as a group.

- HRRP gave the example of the Q&A document which is reviewed and agreed with NRA, and is correct as of time of issue and must be updated as and when required.
- CFP are happy to share any information that is available and has been approved through their enumerators in the districts.
- HRRP is working with MoUD now to find funding to have monthly orientations for DL-PIU engineers in each district. These would be an opportunity to ensure that they are updated on policy changes, information changes, and avoid different engineers having different information.

Q: Many NGOs have completed training of masons, but what has the effectiveness of this been and what are the retention rates? In many areas, the masons are from the Terai and India and are not aware about earthquake resilient construction practices. It would also be useful to know what the gap in terms of trained masons is and how this is affecting construction rates.



- HRRP recommended to focus on delivering full package of technical assistance as training without the other components is not effective. CFP highlighted that the home owners understanding is critical as they will call the shots during construction. Even well trained masons will not be able to push back if the household they are working for requests them to skip some elements of the compliance criteria.
- CFP has also found that young men are not going abroad because they have received mason training, but were just always planning to go abroad. Communities have recommended training women and men over 40 as they are more likely to remain in their villages and work on the reconstruction.
- [HRRP 4W data from 10th March](#) shows that in Dhading, Dolakha, Gorkha, and Rasuwa the plans for masons training will bring the number of trained masons in those districts well over the target. Kavre, Ramechhap, and the three districts in the Kathmandu Valley still have a long way to go to meet the targets.

Q: Is anyone planning to support provision of top up grants for vulnerable groups? As discussed during the presentation, the current HRRP 4W data shows that there are plans to cover only 535 HHs.

- UNDP were not aware of the top-up grant and requested additional information. HRRP informed that these are grants of up to 50,000 NPRs that can be provided to vulnerable groups as an additional support for their reconstruction. More information is available in the [NGO mobilisation guidelines](#).
- Save the Children are providing 45,000 NPRs as top up to 1,600 HHs based on a vulnerability study they are currently conducting. 20,000 NPRs will be provided after the plinth is complete and the remainder will be provided on completion of the house. The top up is focused more on transportation and households are encouraged to pool resources to get maximum return from the top up. 5,000 NPRs is used to pay for the mobile masons.

Q: Nepal EU Action for Reconstruction and Recovery (NEARR) representative asked if there is a power of attorney structure that can support with issues regarding identification that are linked to disbursement of the first tranche and if anyone had done any work with banks on this?

- HRRP highlighted that over 85% of eligible households have received the first tranche which is great, and the initial results from the latest round of the CFP survey seem to show a roughly 10% decrease in the number of people reporting that they have been excluded due to their name not being on the list. NRA have been steadily going through grievances and over 83,000 have already been addressed.
- CFP informed that they have been seeing cases of women whose husbands are overseas and were named during enrolment as the head of household, and who have their marriage certificate and an attestation from the VDC being unable to withdraw the first tranche from the bank.
- Cordaid requested information on when their grievances will be addressed and HRRP informed that POs can follow up about grievances but it is important to note that NRA are steadily working through them and have already cleared a large number. It was also suggested that Cordaid's programmes should not be held up due to grievances as technical assistance in rural areas should be blanket coverage and not tied to the eligibility for the grant.
- The NRA Joint Secretary informed that CDO now has increased rights to address grievances at district level which should speed up the process. Cordaid were concerned that as CDOs regularly change this might impact negatively on the grievance process but the NRA assured that the personnel may change but the process will remain.

Before closing the session, CFP and HRRP requested the participants to commit to going back to their organisation to, at minimum, look at how they can support with the vulnerable top-up grants and expansion of the full package of technical assistance.



Action Points

Actions	Responsible / Committed	Timeframe
Technical Assistance:		
Equip staff at VDC level with skills to be able to communicate effectively with communities	POs, MoUD DL-PIUs, MoUD CL-PIU, MoFALD	As soon as possible, continuous
Expand coverage of door to door technical assistance teams: - Collect FAQs from communities and share to HRRP for compilation and dissemination, - Provide budgeting and finance information, - Orientations for political / community leaders, - Improve targeting of TA particularly to provide women with info that they need	POs, MoUD DL-PIUs, DL-PIU engineers	As soon as possible, continuous
Expand coverage of helpdesks/technical resource centres: - Provide design preparation and approval support for HHs / Communities, - Provide budgeting and finance information, - Orientations for vendors and producers, info and demos on material quality	POs, MoUD DL-PIUs, DL-PIU engineers	As soon as possible, continuous
Monthly orientations for VDC level reconstruction staff / teams (GoN and POs)	MoFALD and MoUD CL-PIUs and DL-PIUs, NRA, HRRP, POs	Launch April / May
Mapping of communications activities	NRA Communications team, HRRP	End April
Training:		
Monitor quality of training	Training providers	As soon as possible, continuous
Provide refresher training for masons	Training providers	As soon as possible, continuous
Redistribute planned investment in training to have even coverage	Training providers, donors	As soon as possible, continuous
Proper selection of participants for training courses based on relevant criteria	Training providers	As soon as possible, continuous
Expand opportunities for training for women and men over 40	Training providers	As soon as possible, continuous
Top Up Grants: expand coverage for vulnerable/remote HHs	POs	As soon as possible
Supply Chain: assessment and development of plan based on assessment findings	NRA, MoUD / DUDBC, HRRP, Practical Action, POs in districts	End May
Water Supply: Update information on water sources, prepare plan to maximise investment in water supply programmes to support HHs with reconstruction	HRRP, DWSS / WASH Cluster, NRA, POs with WASH programmes	End May



CFP and HRRP will be following up with the participants in the session directly to try to secure more precise commitments in relation to the actions above. Please feel free to contact the presenters, contact details are provided below, if your organisation can contribute to any of the above.

Reference Documents

- [CFP Reconstruction Report, February 2017](#)
- [CFP Focus Group Discussion Report, January 2017](#)
- [Contact details for District Focal Points for DL-PIU engineers](#): able to provide contact details for DL-PIU engineers at VDC level.
- [Sakcham programme financial capability resources, you tube channel](#)
- [NRA map of water sources, May 2016](#)
- [NRA map of damage grade, 14 districts](#)
- [Maps of coverage of full package of technical assistance](#)
- [Nepal National Building Code, revised NBC 202, 203, 204, and 205](#)
- [JICA Minimum Requirements Booklets for Households](#)
- [JICA Masons Training Survey Format](#)
- [JICA Refresher Training for Masons](#)
- [HRRP Briefing Pack](#)
- [HRRP Weekly Bulletins](#)
- [HRRP Q&A, Nepali translation of community FAQs](#)
- [HRRP District Profiles based on 10th March 4W data](#)

Contact Details

Contact details for the presenters are provided below to facilitate follow up on any of the topics covered in the session.

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